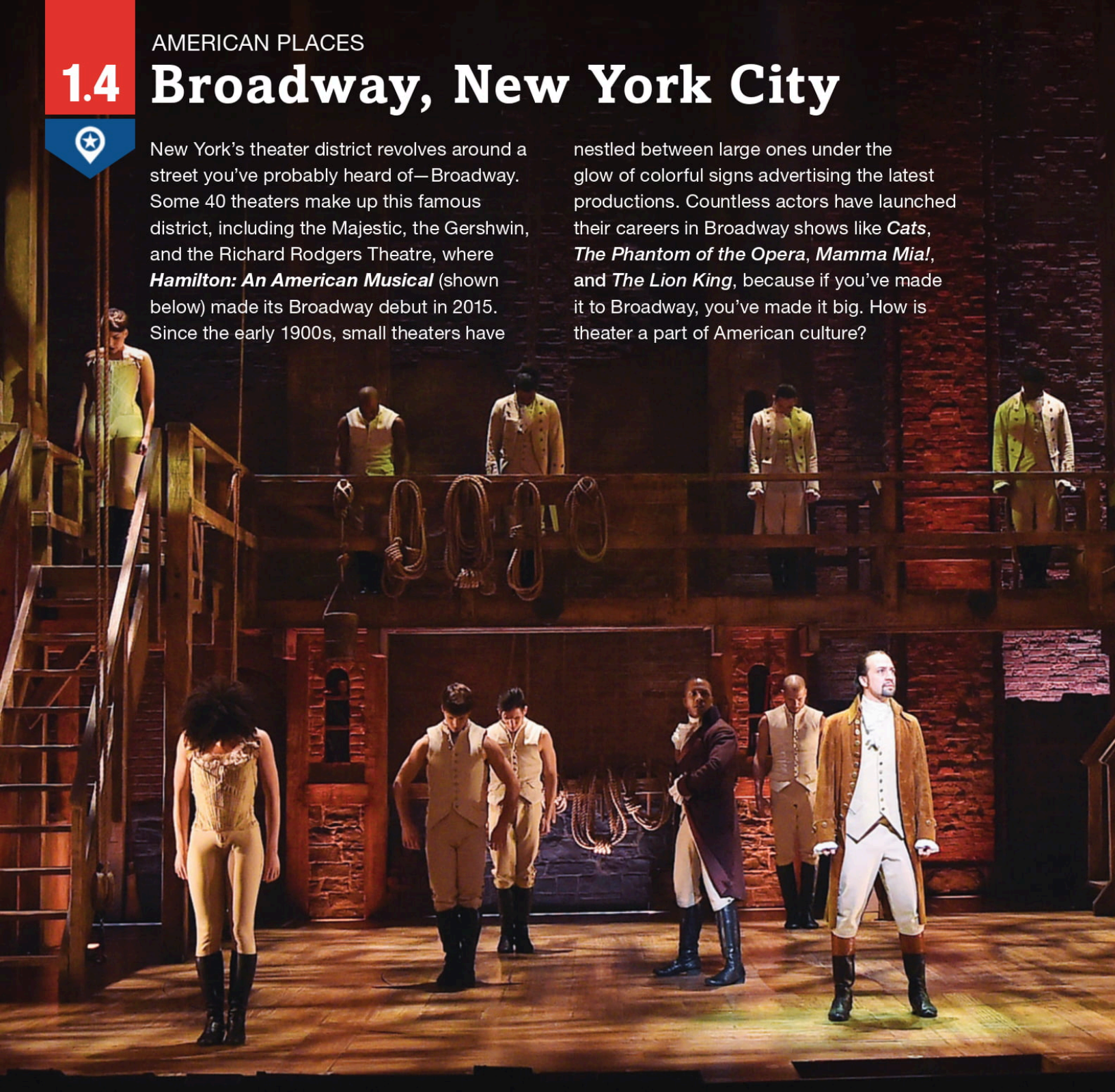
AMERICAN PLACES

1.4 Broadway, New York City

New York's theater district revolves around a street you've probably heard of—Broadway. Some 40 theaters make up this famous district, including the Majestic, the Gershwin, and the Richard Rodgers Theatre, where ***Hamilton: An American Musical*** (shown below) made its Broadway debut in 2015. Since the early 1900s, small theaters have nestled between large ones under the glow of colorful signs advertising the latest productions. Countless actors have launched their careers in Broadway shows like ***Cats***, ***The Phantom of the Opera***, ***Mamma Mia!***, and ***The Lion King***, because if you've made it to Broadway, you've made it big. How is theater a part of American culture?



"My name is Alexander Hamilton
And there's a million things I haven't done
But just you wait
Just you wait."

—lyrics from the song "Alexander Hamilton"
by Lin-Manuel Miranda

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CRITICAL VIEWING Tony Award-winning *Hamilton* is likely the most unique Broadway production in decades. The hip-hop musical tells the story of Founding Father Alexander Hamilton, who authored several of the Federalist Papers. Actor Lin-Manuel Miranda (center) played Hamilton on Broadway to sold-out crowds and critical acclaim. Based on the photo, how do you think *Hamilton* connects a modern audience to American history?

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